# Compressed Air Tank Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1910.169)

Use for each air receiver when it is installed and at every routine site inspection.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.169

| DATE | SHIFT |
|---|---|
| INSPECTOR | AREA / EQUIPMENT ID |

**Before you start**

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A for each air receiver, and note the receiver's location or ID.
2. For any Defect, record what you found, report it to the person responsible for the compressed air system and have it corrected.
3. The manufacturer's instructions and site rules may add checks to this list.

**Legal basis:** 29 CFR 1910.169: Air receivers (Part 1910 Subpart M, Compressed Gas and Compressed Air Equipment) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09 ASME Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code, Section VIII (1968 edition), incorporated by reference in 29 CFR 1910.6

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-169-air-receivers

## SECTION A | Construction code

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Receiver construction code<br>Ref. 1910.169(a)(2)(i) | A receiver installed after the effective date of the regulations is constructed to ASME BPVC Section VIII, 1968 edition | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 2 | Safety valve construction<br>Ref. 1910.169(a)(2)(ii) | Each safety valve is constructed to ASME BPVC Section VIII, 1968 edition | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 3 | Safety valve installation and maintenance<br>Ref. 1910.169(a)(2)(ii) | Each safety valve is installed and maintained to ASME BPVC Section VIII, 1968 edition | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |

## SECTION B | Location, access and drainage

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | Access to drains and openings<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(1) | The drain valve, handholes and manholes can all be reached easily, with nothing stored or built in front of them | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 5 | Receiver location<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(1) | The receiver is not buried underground and is not in an inaccessible place | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 6 | Drain pipe and valve<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(2) | A drain pipe and valve are fitted at the lowest point of the receiver | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 7 | Draining<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(2) | Opening the drain valve empties the receiver completely, and no excessive oil or water collects between drainings | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 8 | Automatic trap (if fitted)<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(2) | Any automatic trap is fitted in addition to a drain valve, which is still present | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |

## SECTION C | Pressure gage and safety valves

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | Pressure gage<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(3)(i) | An indicating pressure gage is fitted and readily visible, not hidden or obscured | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |


General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

## SECTION C | Pressure gage and safety valves

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | Safety valves present<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(3)(i) | At least one spring-loaded safety valve is fitted to the receiver | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 11 | Relieving capacity<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(3)(i) | Combined safety valve capacity keeps receiver pressure within 10 percent above its MAWP | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12 | No valve before safety valve<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(3)(ii) | No valve of any type sits between the receiver and any of its safety valves | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |

## SECTION D | Protection and testing of safety appliances

| No. | Check item | What to look for | OK | Defect | N/A | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13 | Safety valves operable<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(3)(iii) | No safety valve is blocked, tied or plugged, or set up so it could readily be made inoperative | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 14 | Gages and controls operable<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(3)(iii) | Indicating and controlling devices are installed so they cannot readily be disabled | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 15 | Protection from the elements<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(3)(iii) | Exposure to the elements cannot readily put any safety valve, gage or control out of action | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 16 | Safety valve testing<br>Ref. 1910.169(b)(3)(iv) | Safety valves are tested frequently and at regular intervals, and the latest test found them in good operating condition | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |

## DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

| Item no. | Defect description | Reported to | Action taken / date closed |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

## SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service

| INSPECTOR SIGNATURE | DATE / TIME |
|---|---|
| SUPERVISOR REVIEW | DATE / TIME |


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